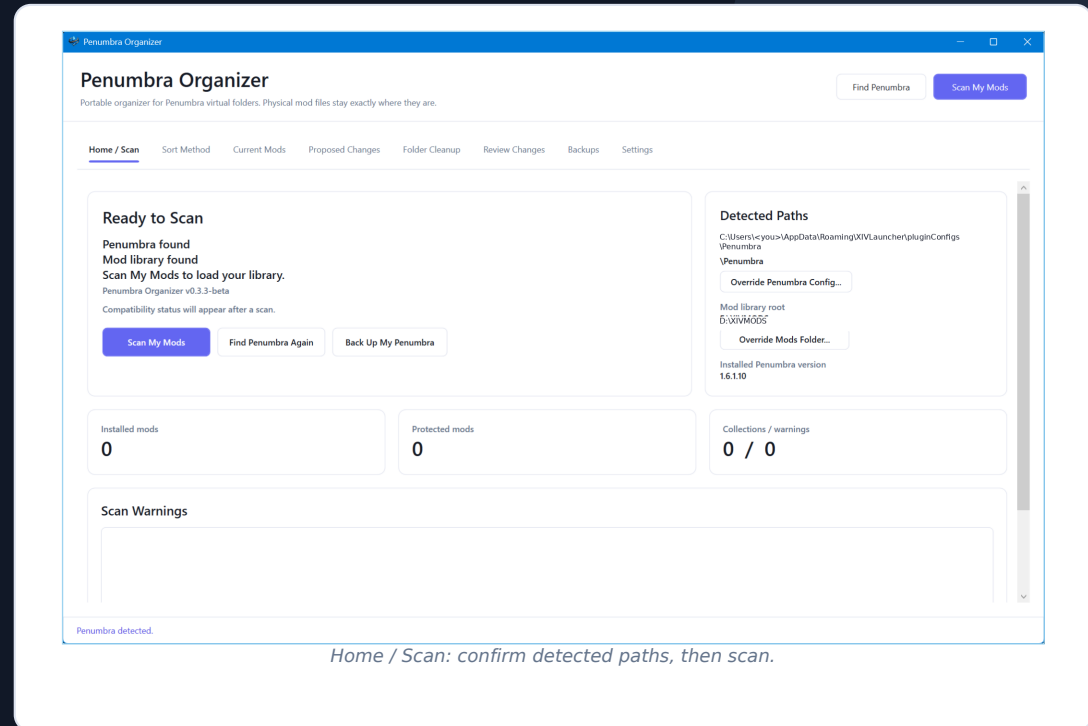


How to Use Penumbra Organizer



What this app does

Reorganizes Penumbra virtual mod folders without touching physical mod files.

Safety basics

Scan is read-only. Nothing writes until Backup and Apply. Backups are verified.

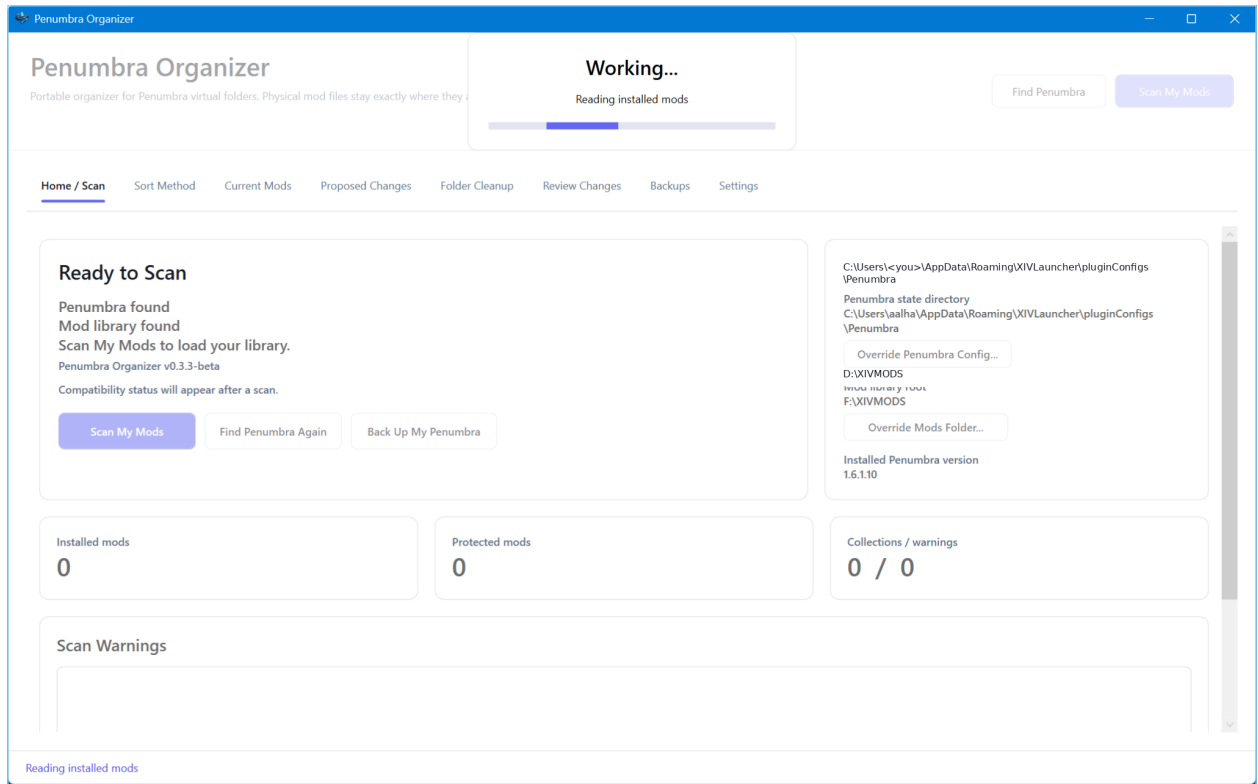
Before you start

Windows 10/11, XIVLauncher/Dalamud with Penumbra, and FFXIV closed before applying.

Scanning

The app reads installed mods and disables write actions while scanning.

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The app reads installed mods and disables write actions while scanning.

Read-only operation

This step only reads your current setup and changes nothing.

Detected paths

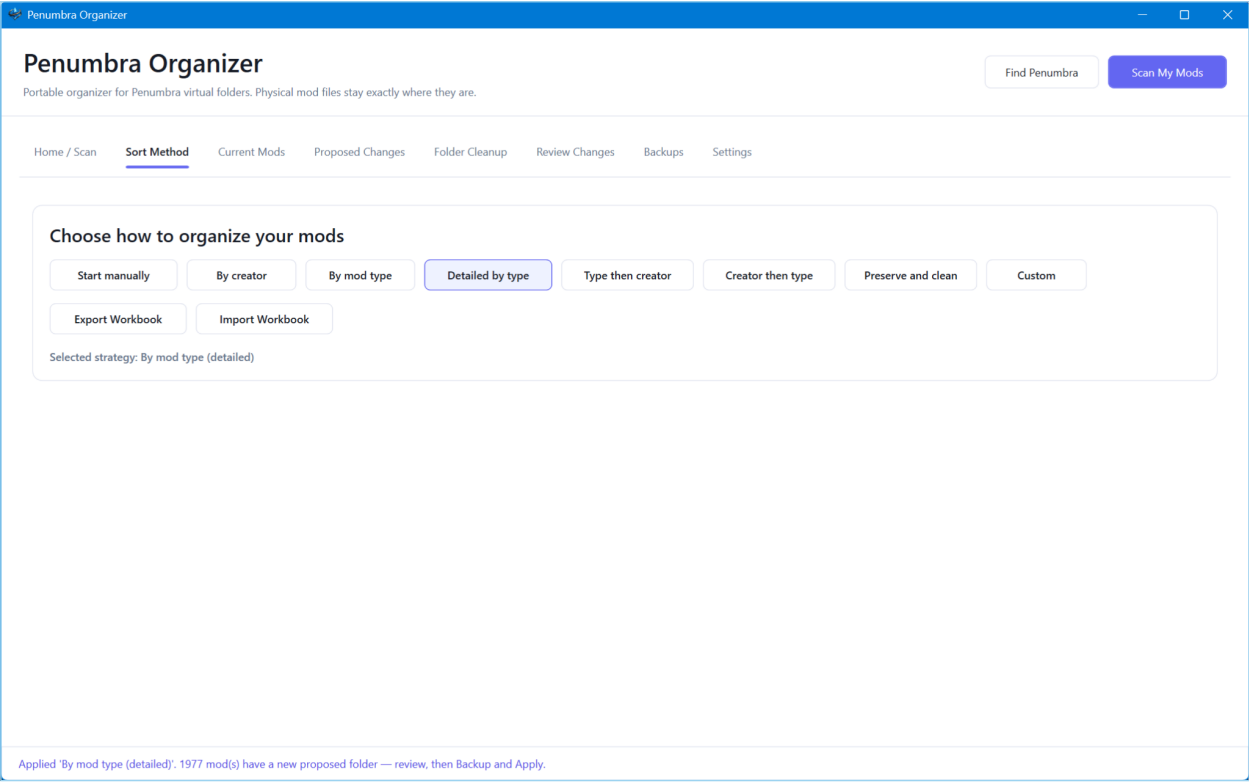
Confirm the Penumbra state directory and mod library root before continuing.

Next step

After the scan completes, choose a Sort Method.

Sort Method

Pick how proposals are generated.



Pick how proposals are generated.

Strategy choices

Manual, creator, mod type, detailed type, nested type/creator, Preserve and clean, or Custom.

Proposal only

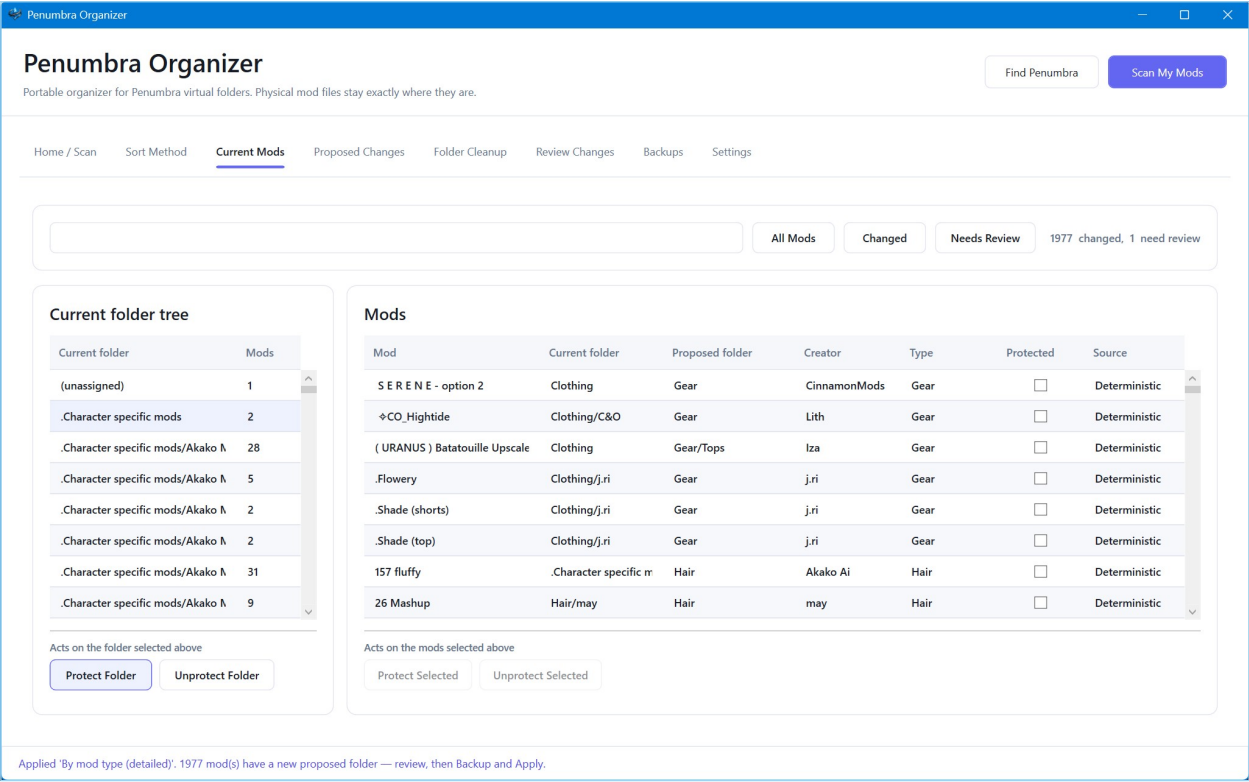
Selecting a strategy builds a plan; it does not write to Penumbra.

Workbook option

Export/import a workbook if you prefer spreadsheet planning.

Current Mods

Filter your library and protect selected mods or folders.



Filter your library and protect selected mods or folders.

Protect selected mods

Use this when individual mods should never move.

Protect folder

Use this when everything under a folder should be skipped.

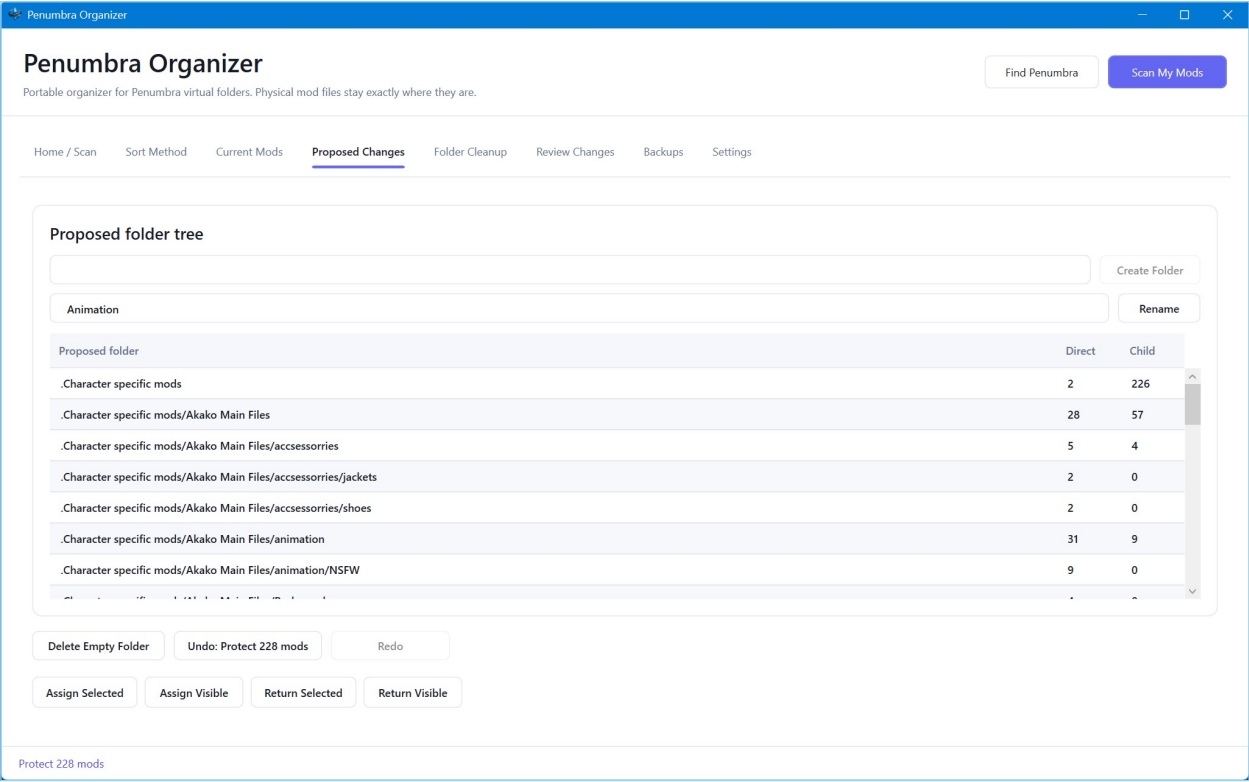
Rule

Protected mods and folders are skipped by every strategy and every Apply.

Proposed Changes

Inspect the target tree and adjust assignments.

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Inspect the target tree and adjust assignments.

Manual corrections

Create/rename folders, assign selected or visible mods, and return items as needed.

Undo / Redo

Back out individual assignment edits before review.

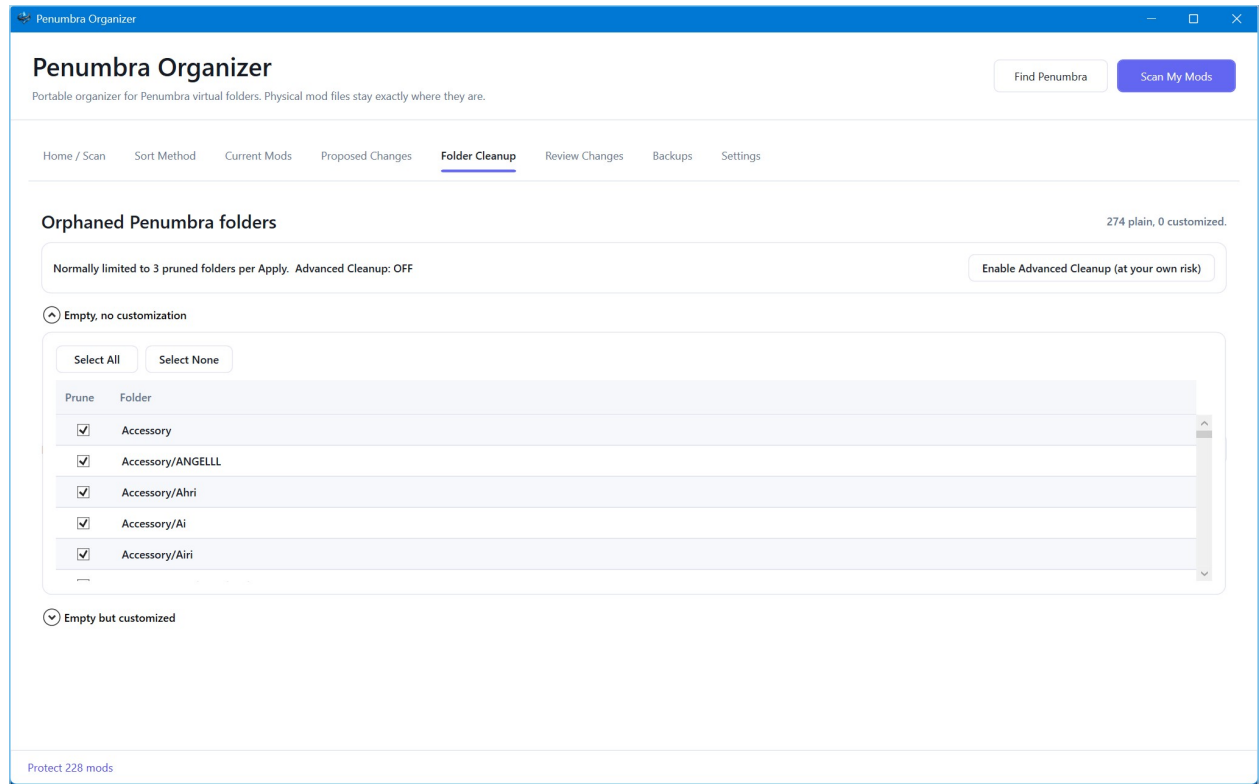
Review next

When the proposal looks right, continue to Review Changes.

Folder Cleanup

Optionally prune orphaned empty folders from organization.json.

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Optionally prune orphaned empty folders from organization.json.

Why it exists

Penumbra can keep old empty folder nodes in organization.json and recreate them on load.

Default limit

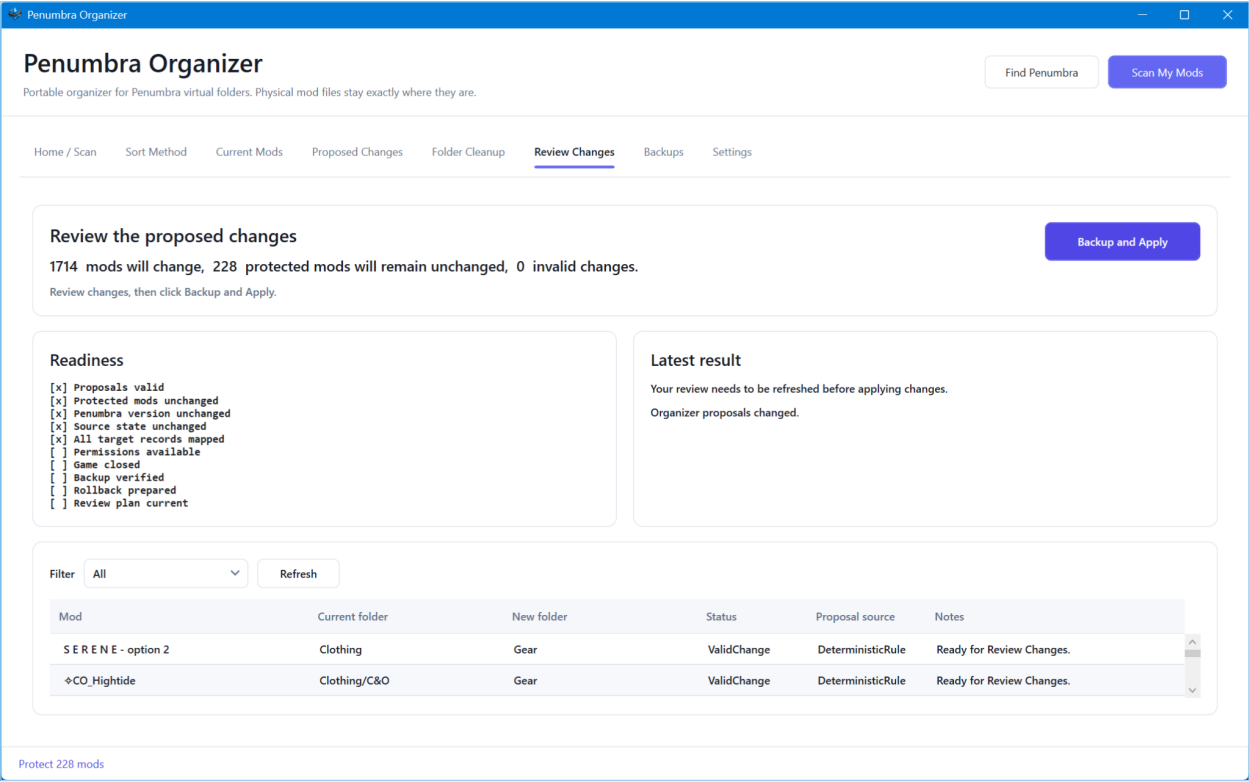
Cleanup is limited to 3 pruned folders per Apply by default.

Advanced Cleanup

Use only for large orphan sets and only after a manual backup.

Review Changes

Validation checks must pass before changes are applied.



Validation checks must pass before changes are applied.

Readiness

Resolve invalid changes, permission issues, or stale review state before applying.

Close FFXIV

Close the game completely before writing Penumbra configuration files.

Apply button

Backup and Apply becomes the final write path after validation.

Final Confirmation

Confirm planned virtual-folder changes before writing.

Apply Virtual-Folder Changes?

Apply Virtual-Folder Changes?

A verified backup is ready. If you continue, the app will update Penumbra's virtual-folder database without moving any physical mod files.

1714 mod(s) will be reorganized.
228 protected mod(s) will remain unchanged.

Planned folder changes:
S E R E N E - option 2: Clothing -> Gear
✦CO_Hightide: Clothing/C&O -> Gear
(URANUS) Batatouille Upscale: Clothing -> Gear/Tops
.Flowery: Clothing/j.ri -> Gear
.Shade (shorts): Clothing/j.ri -> Gear
.Shade (top): Clothing/j.ri -> Gear
26 Mashup: Hair/may -> Hair
26 Mashup: Hair/may -> Hair
+ 1706 more

Authoritative targets: none
Write operations: 1
Backup location: %LocalAppData%\PenumbraOrganizer\Backups\...
Rollback readiness: Prepared

Cancel

Backup and Apply

Confirm planned virtual-folder changes before writing.

Verified backup ready

The app creates a verified backup before it writes anything.

Review summary

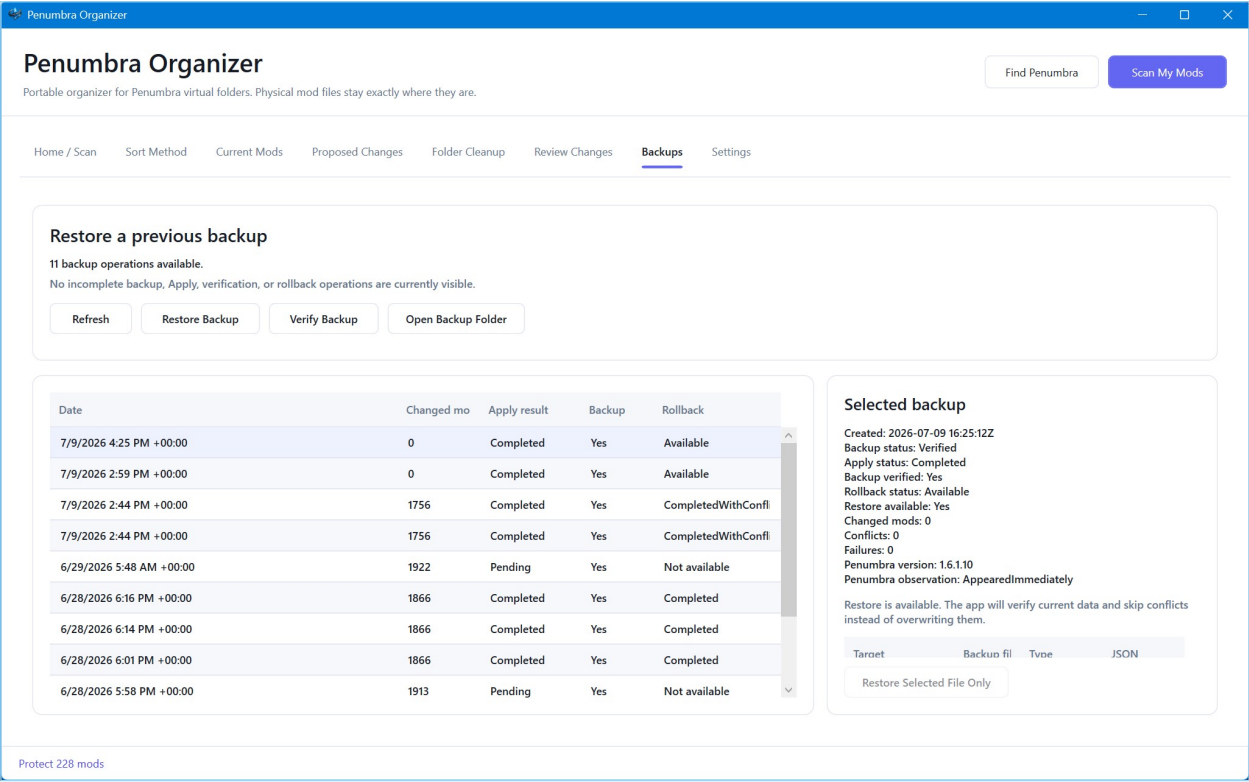
Check changed mod count, protected count, planned folder changes, write operations, and rollback readiness.

Apply

Continue only when the summary matches what you intend.

Backups

Verify backups, restore previous operations, or restore one selected file.



Verify backups, restore previous operations, or restore one selected file.

Restore Backup

Rolls back an entire previous operation.

Restore Selected File Only

Rolls back one file, such as organization.json, without touching anything else.

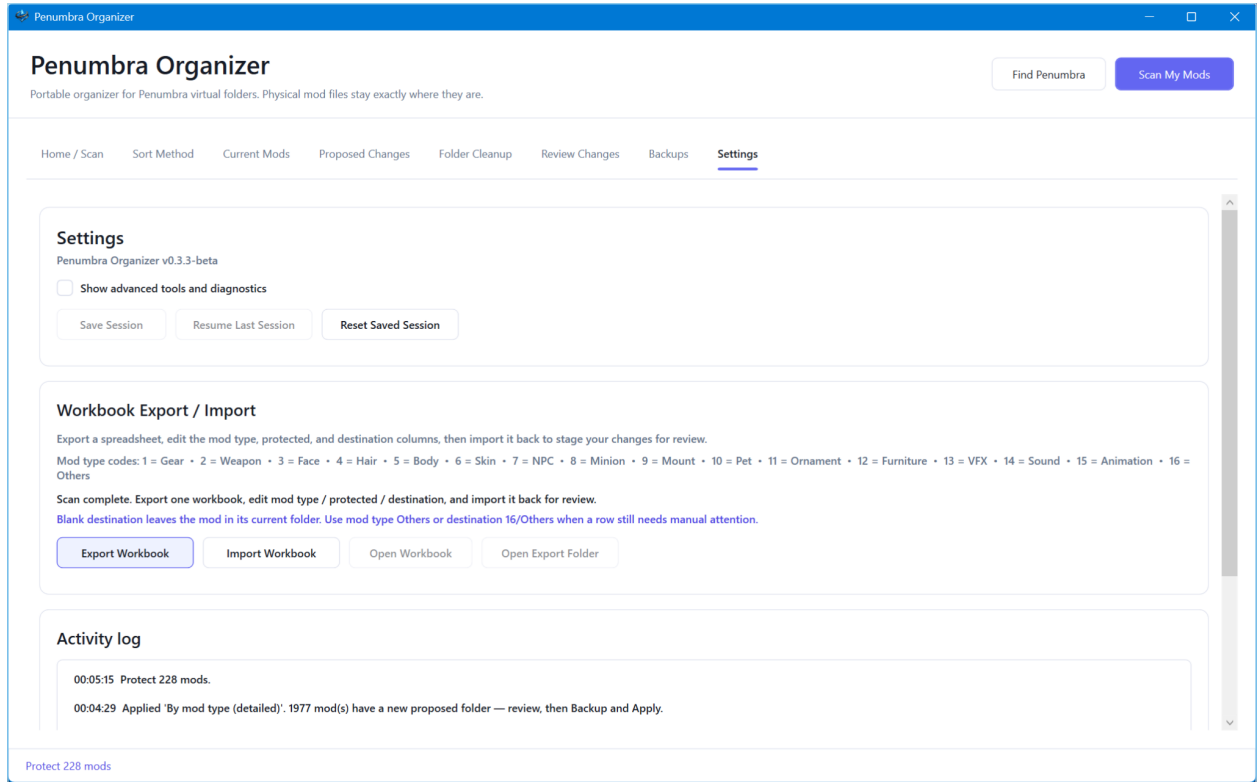
Caution

Restoring organization.json alone can bring back orphaned folders.

Settings and Workbook Tools

Advanced tools, workbook export/import, and activity log.

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Advanced tools, workbook export/import, and activity log.

Settings

Advanced tools and diagnostics live here.

Workbook export/import

Export a spreadsheet, edit mod type/protected/destination, then import it back.

Activity log

Use the log area to confirm recent operations and troubleshooting steps.

Edit rows in a spreadsheet, then import back into Penumbra Organizer.

Edit rows in a spreadsheet, then import back into Penumbra Organizer.

Edit rows in a spreadsheet, then import back into Penumbra Organizer.

Edit mod type, protected, and destination columns.

Edit mod type, protected, and destination columns.

Microsoft Excel is not required; LibreOffice Calc works too.

Microsoft Excel is not required; LibreOffice Calc works too.

When reporting issues, include versions, clicked steps, exact error, and sanitized logs. Do not upload mod files or credentials.

When reporting issues, include versions, clicked steps, exact error, and sanitized logs. Do not upload mod files or credentials.